

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 648

By Reedy

A RESOLUTION to recognize and honor Judge Andy Brigham for bringing CASA to Stewart County.

WHEREAS, we are pleased to honor an outstanding jurist who has faithfully discharged his duties for many years, working compassionately and diligently to ensure that all who come before him are treated with dignity and respect; and

WHEREAS, Judge Andy Brigham of Stewart County is a notable jurist, who is most worthy of our approbation; and

WHEREAS, a longtime judge who has served the citizens of Stewart County with integrity and aplomb, Judge Brigham has worked tirelessly to ensure that at-risk youth who have cases before him are well advocated for, treating them with respect and enabling them to have a voice; and

WHEREAS, for fourteen years, Judge Brigham led the charge to bring CASA (Court Appointed Special Advocates) to Stewart County, staying the course and fighting for this important program, thus improving the experiences and outcomes for children throughout the county; and

WHEREAS, CASA programs operate throughout the country as a unique blend of private support, public need, and the kind of people power that comes from 70,000 volunteers committed to the rights of every child in the foster care and child welfare system; and

WHEREAS, CASA volunteers meet with children monthly and build a caring, trusting relationship, offering support to these children and a chance for their experiences and needs to be considered in legal matters; and

WHEREAS, Judge Andy Brigham's effort to bring CASA to Stewart County is one of many examples of his commitment to treating everyone with dignity and respect and making sure each individual has representation in court; and

WHEREAS, through his compassionate action, Judge Brigham has inspired others to be better people; he was recently duly honored during the "My Hero" segment on News Channel 5 Nashville for his important work; and

WHEREAS, the well-being and safety of our children are of paramount importance to our future, and CASA is a vital program that helps to ensure that well-being and safety; and

WHEREAS, throughout his estimable career, the Honorable Andy Brigham has demonstrated the utmost professionalism, ability, and integrity, winning the respect and admiration of members of the bench and bar alike, the parties appearing before his court, and the citizens of the State of Tennessee; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Judge Andy Brigham for his unparalleled service to the youth of Tennessee, applauding his effort to bring CASA to Stewart County and wishing him every continued success in his future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.